

Announcements

- EAG NY applications due 27 September
 - Anyone can (and everyone should) apply!
- Coworking space: CARES Hub! (ARMS 1261)



Preorder and read Obsolete!



OUT SEPTEMBER 29, 2026 • NATION BOOKS

OBSOLETE

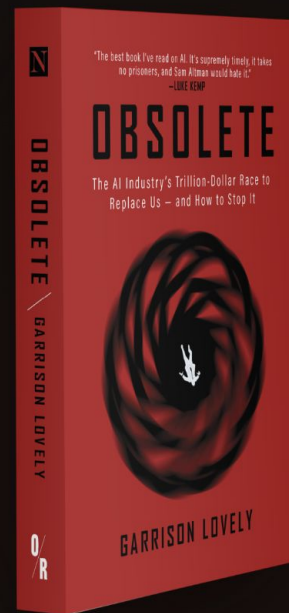
The AI Industry's Trillion-Dollar Race to Replace Us – and How to Stop It

BY GARRISON LOVELY

Is AI a bubble or humanity's last invention? An existing harm or existential threat? *Obsolete* cuts through the hype and false binaries to answer all the AI questions you have, while raising some you probably aren't prepared for.

[PRE-ORDER THE BOOK →](#)

[PRESS INQUIRIES](#)



Have you heard about the Super El Niño?

A check-in on the climate and other looming crises through an EA lens

By Tate Schwartz



Part 1:

Climate change is bad



Remember the Paris Climate Agreement?

2015:

“Work together to make sure the average temperature does NOT reach 1.5 degrees Celsius above pre-industrial levels”

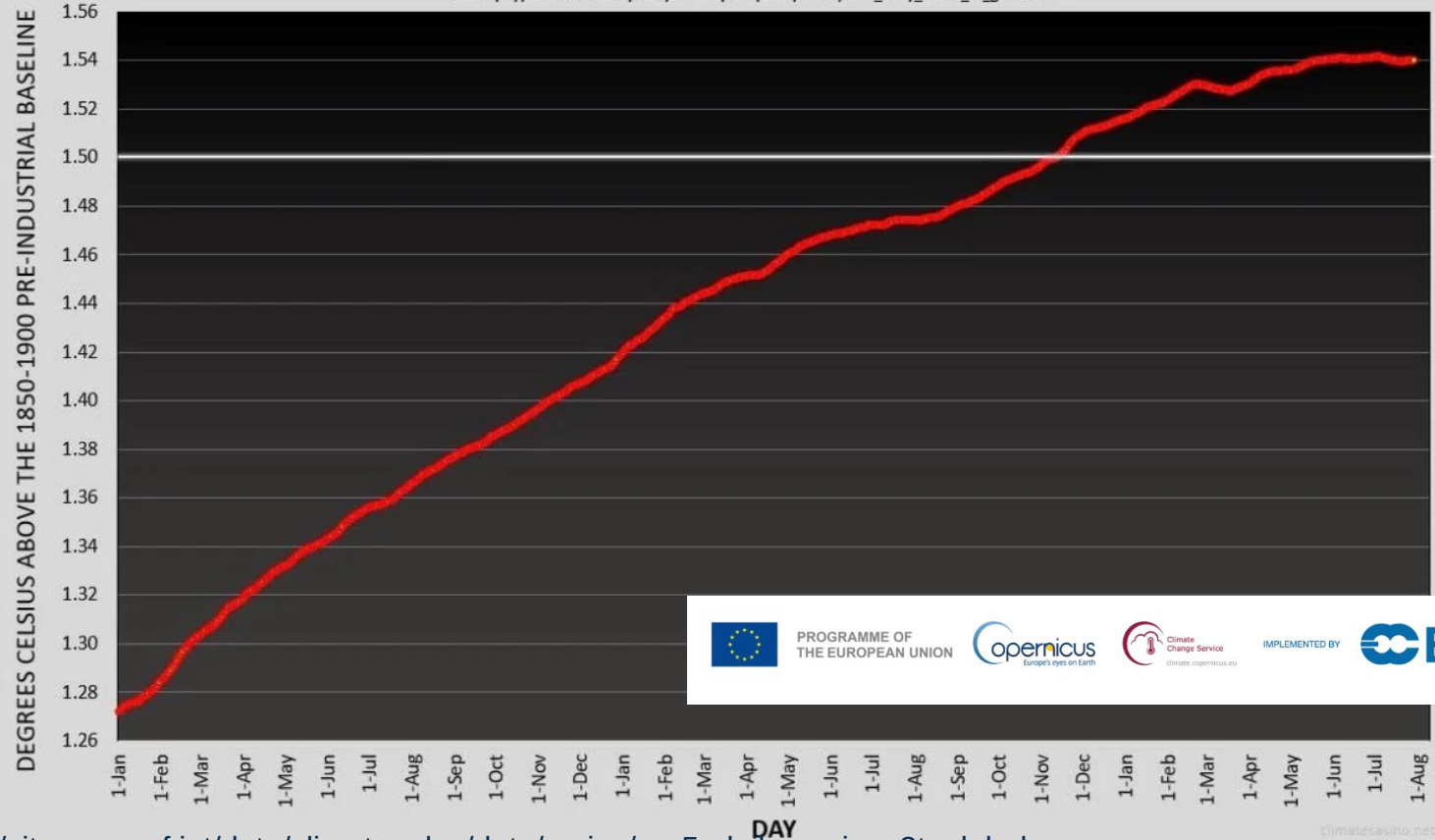
“It will be bad and irreversible”

— The experts and world governments



Global Mean Surface Temperature Anomaly: 3-Year Running Mean January 1, 2024 - July 29, 2026

Data: https://sites.ecmwf.int/data/climatepulse/data/series/era5_daily_series_2t_global.csv



https://sites.ecmwf.int/data/climatepulse/data/series/era5_daily_series_2t_global.csv

climatecasino.net



+2 degrees Celsius is leaving the Holocene

a.k.a. the stable climate epoch that let humanity not go extinct

a.k.a. there are days of the year where the body can't lose heat by sweating

“A more achievable, though still difficult, goal is limiting warming to 2°C, which would require emissions to drop around 35 per cent by 2035. Current national commitments, if fully implemented, would cut emissions only 12 to 15 per cent by that date — leaving the world well off target.” —UN

<https://www.unep.org/news-and-stories/story/world-likely-exceed-key-global-warming-target-soon-now-what>
<https://www.forbes.com/sites/roberthart/2021/11/09/1-billion-people-at-risk-from-potentially-lethal-heat-if-global-warming-passes-2c-scientists-warn/>



What does Founder's Pledge have to say?

Not a priority in terms of existential risks. Too much money already. Too crowded.

- Fund geothermal and nuclear tech
- Fund efforts to make new infrastructure as low-carbon as possible
- Fund advocacy for neglected ideas
- Fund campaigns that will make climate policy more resilient to administration change

<https://www.founderspledge.com/programs/climate-fund/about>



What do you think of climate as an existential risk cause area also compared to AI safety or biosecurity?

Which of these ideas do you like the best?

- Fund geothermal and nuclear energy tech
- Fund efforts to make new infrastructure as low-carbon as possible (instead of replace old)
- Fund advocacy for neglected ideas
- Fund campaigns that will make climate policy more resilient to administration change



Part 2:

**Climate change is bad
next year**



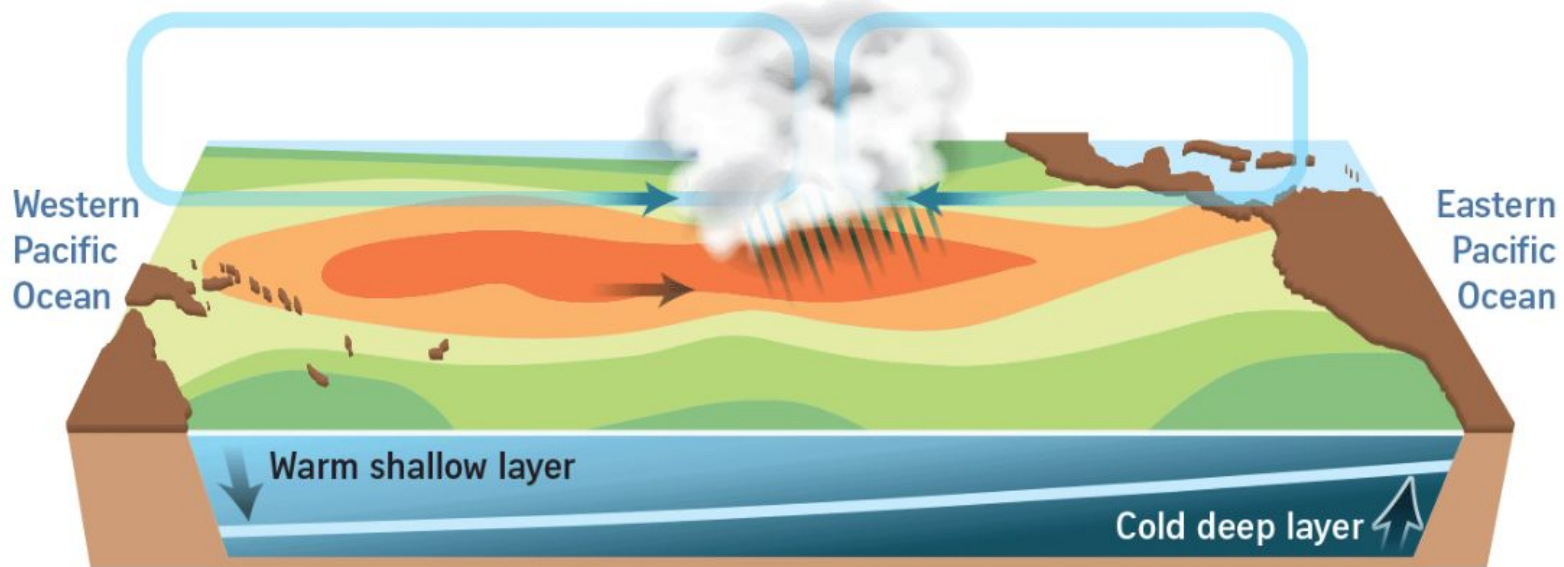


EL NINO CONDITIONS

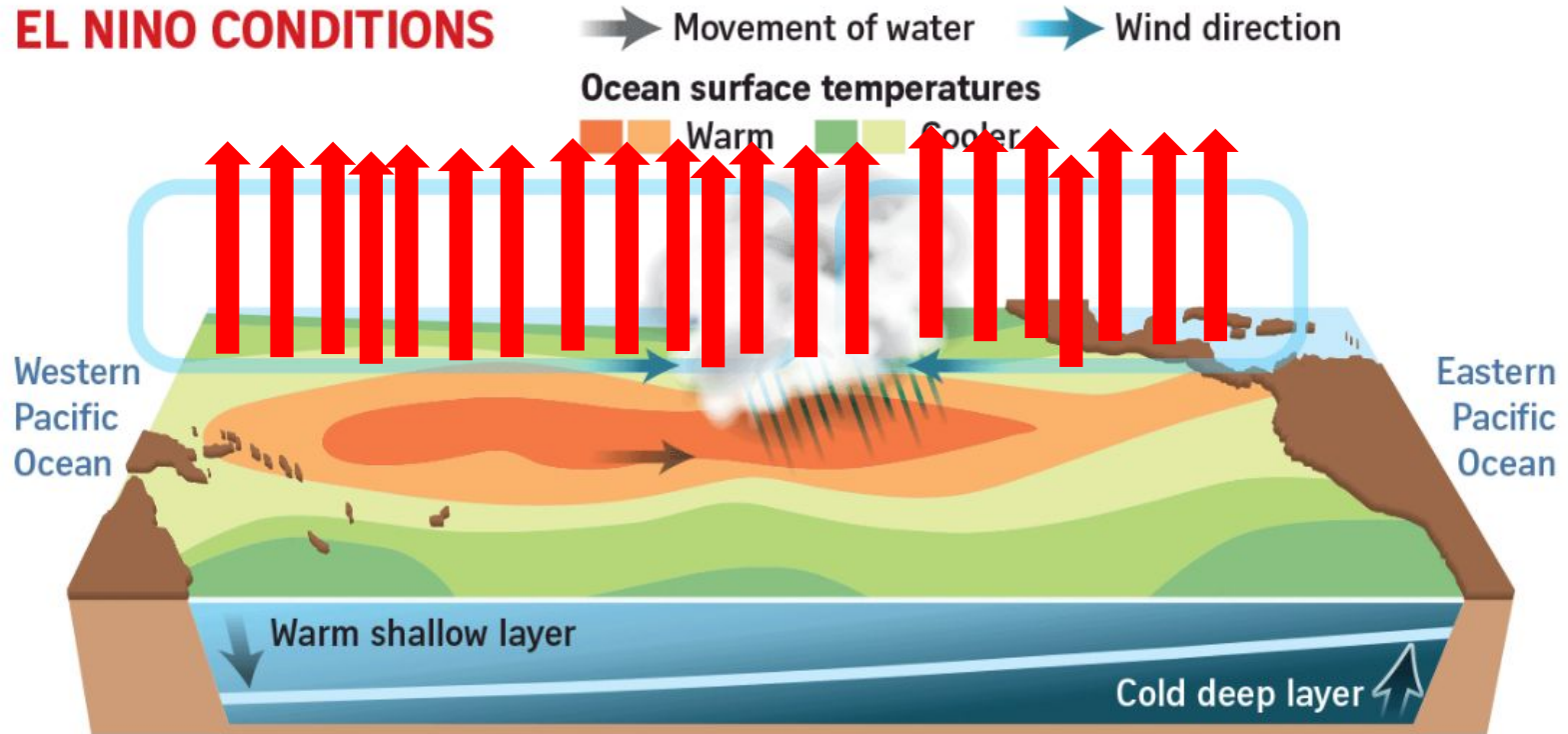
→ Movement of water → Wind direction

Ocean surface temperatures

Warm Cooler

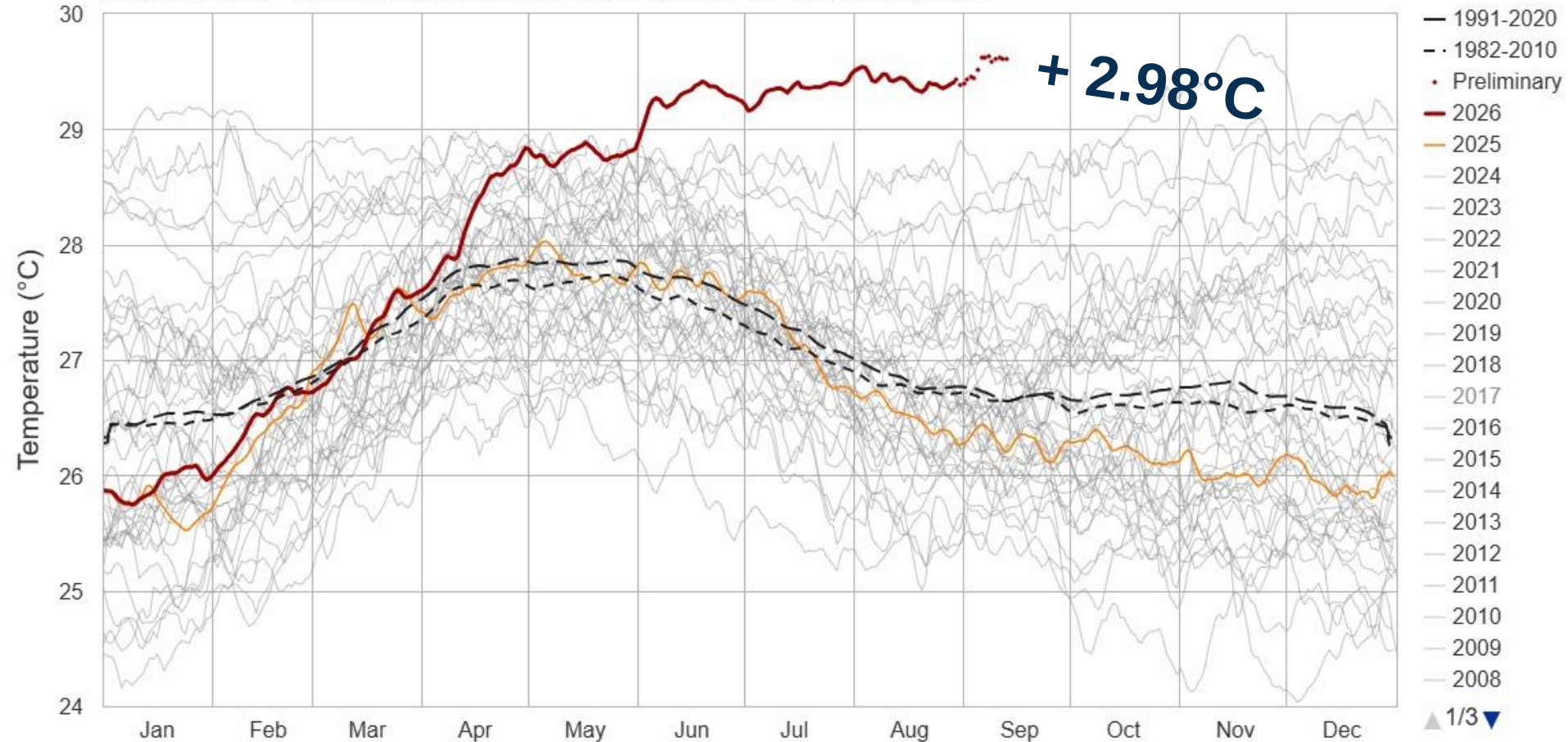


EL NINO CONDITIONS



Daily Sea Surface Temperature, Niño 3.4 (5°S–5°N, 120–170°W)

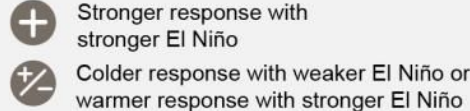
Dataset: NOAA OISST V2.1 | Image Credit: ClimateReanalyzer.org, Climate Change Institute, University of Maine



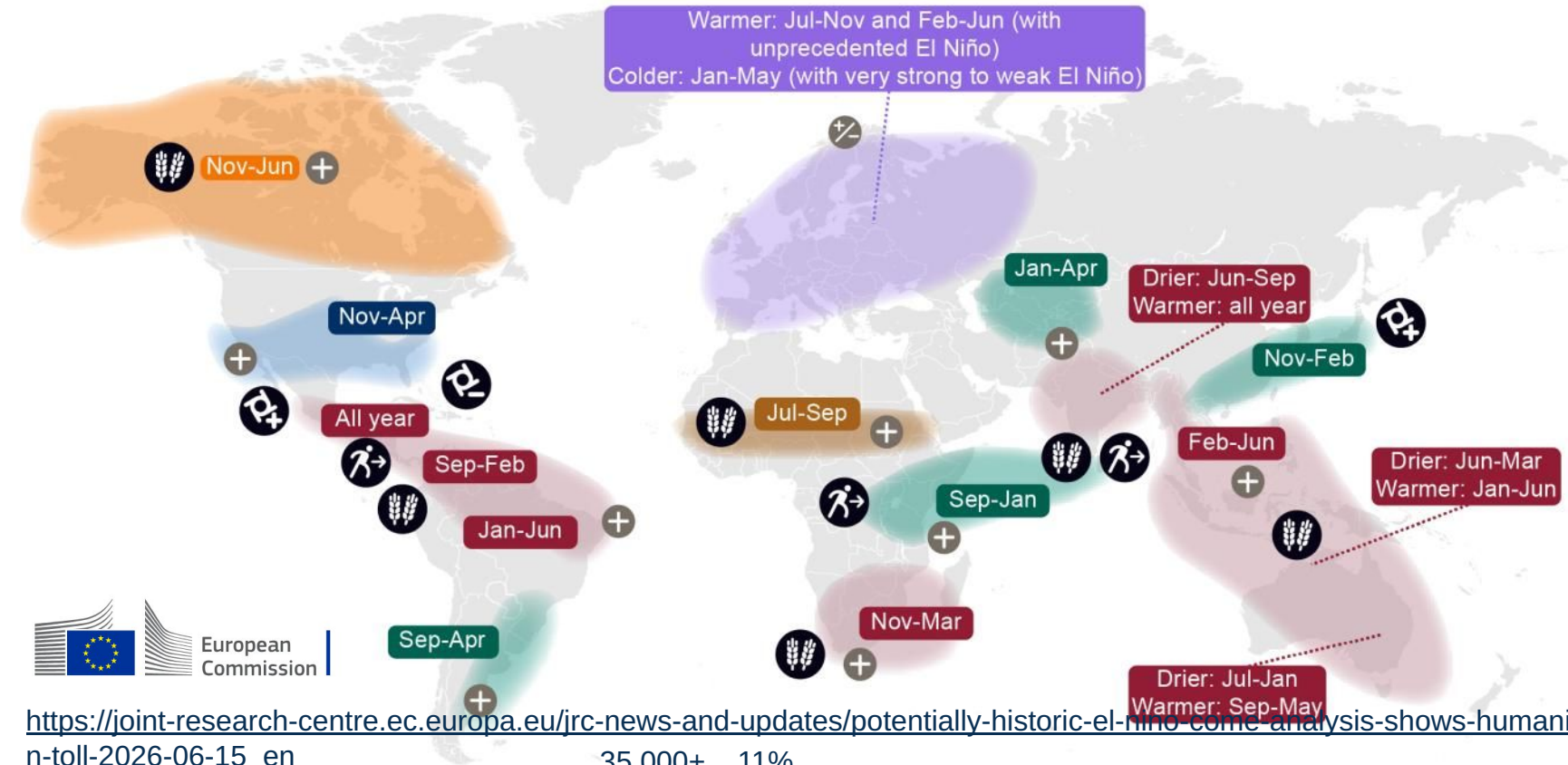
Climate effects:

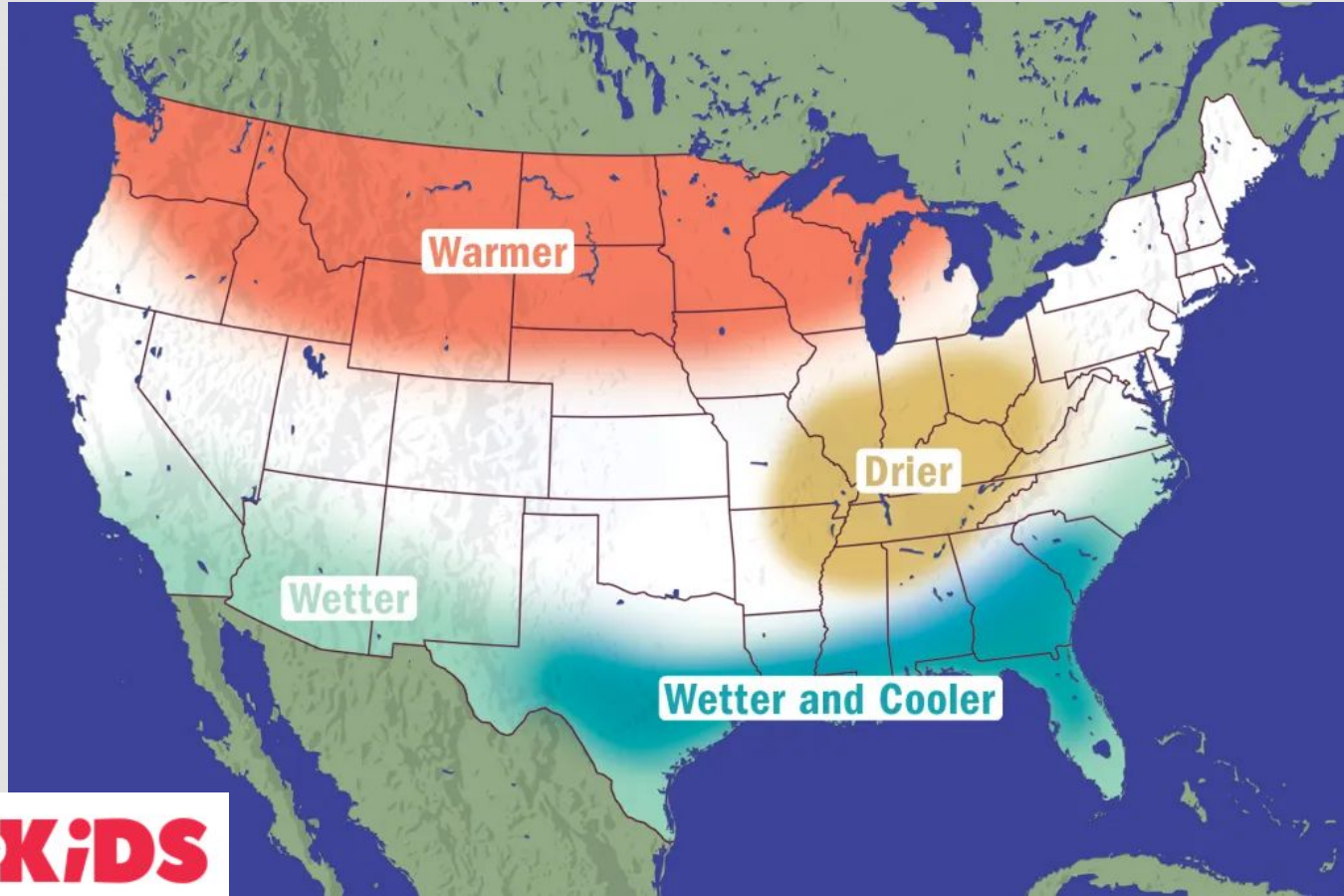


Intensity of climate effects:



Potential impacts:





TIME for **KIDS**

<https://www.timeforkids.com/g34/tfk-explains-el-nino-g3/?rl=en-720>



The Effects

- Heat deaths
- Drought
 - Low food production
 - Low energy production
- Flooding
 - Nepal
 - Indy

“The report cautions that, for the most extreme scenario, its models are extrapolating beyond any historical precedent.”

1997-1998: \$5.7 trillion
2015-2016: \$3.9 trillion in
global economic losses



What do you think about issue awareness as a cause generally?

- Who do you want to care?
- How do you get them to care?

How do you personally forecast + make decisions about uNprEceDEntEd events? (Climate, AI, biosecurity)



Part 3:

Book your flights now



More Facts

- 30% of all fertilizer trade goes through the Strait of Hormuz
- Oil is essential to all US agriculture
 - (diesel and lubricants for equipment and trucks)
- Costco just doubled the prices of their motor oil and set limits on purchasing

<https://www.ifpri.org/blog/the-iran-wars-impacts-on-global-fertilizer-markets-and-food-production/>
<https://www.ttnews.com/articles/trucks-key-movement-agricultural-products-usda-report-finds>
<https://apnews.com/article/costco-motor-oil-diesel-iran-amazon-kirkland-f5fafbcc6f6befe718b61f7cdf3d3e38>



NATIONAL AVERAGE GAS PRICESⁱ

	Regular	Mid-Grade	Premium	Diesel	E85
Current Avg.	\$4.3289	\$4.8316	\$5.2177	\$6.2694	\$3.3036
Yesterday Avg.	\$4.3163	\$4.8026	\$5.1936	\$6.2301	\$3.2852
Week Ago Avg.	\$4.1514	\$4.6338	\$5.0255	\$5.9012	\$3.1267
Month Ago Avg.	\$4.0704	\$4.5833	\$4.9647	\$5.4396	\$3.1420
Year Ago Avg.	\$3.1777	\$3.6520	\$4.0165	\$3.6858	\$2.5615

+ 16 ¢

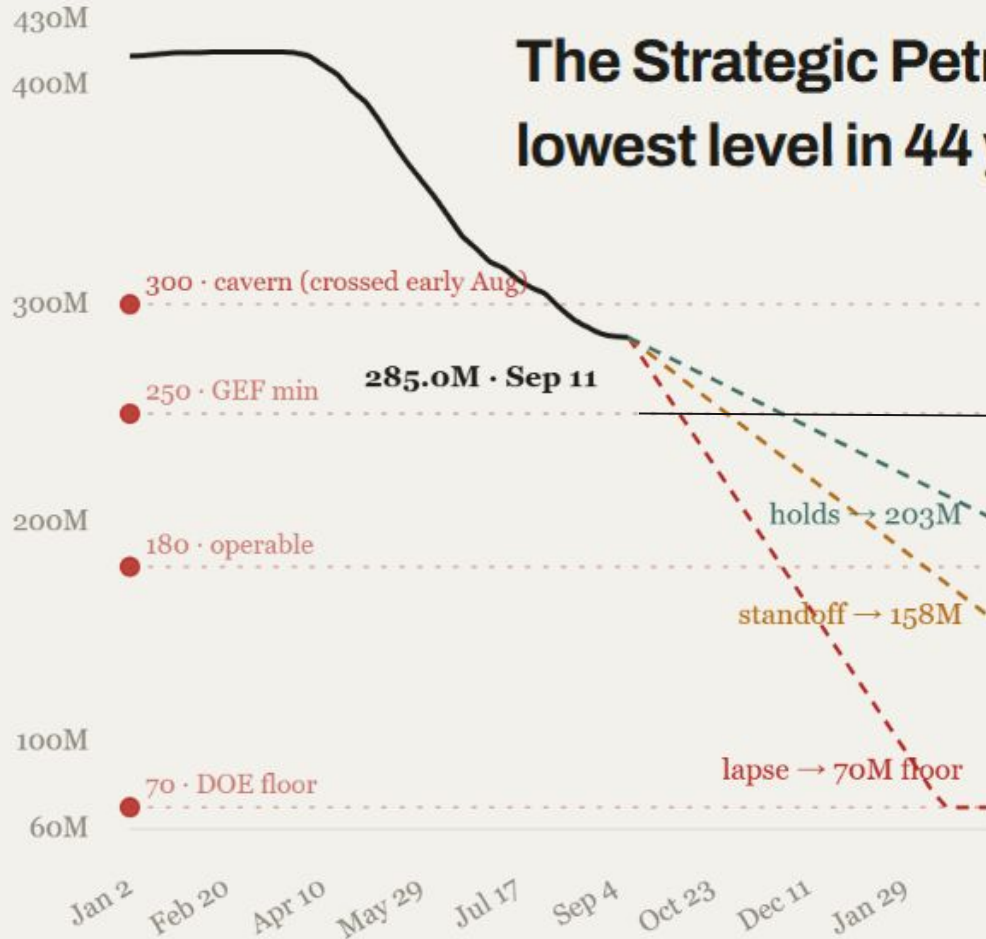
+ 33 ¢

Sept. 14





The Strategic Petroleum Reserve is at its lowest level in 44 years



The line of “the reserve can no longer meaningfully help or subsidize”

Set to be crossed late October.

Travel season is soon.

<https://www.depletion.org/#supply>



Longtermism

Future people matter.

There can be a lot.

We can affect it.

- Prioritizes preventing irreversible damage and total wipeout.



Toby Ord's *The Precipice* puts climate catastrophe at 1/1000 and unaligned AI catastrophe at 1/10.

Is it fair to not prioritize climate change due to its lower speculated odds of extinction?

How do you manage Pascal's mugging? (*where huge speculative effects at extremely low odds could be used to justify anything?*)



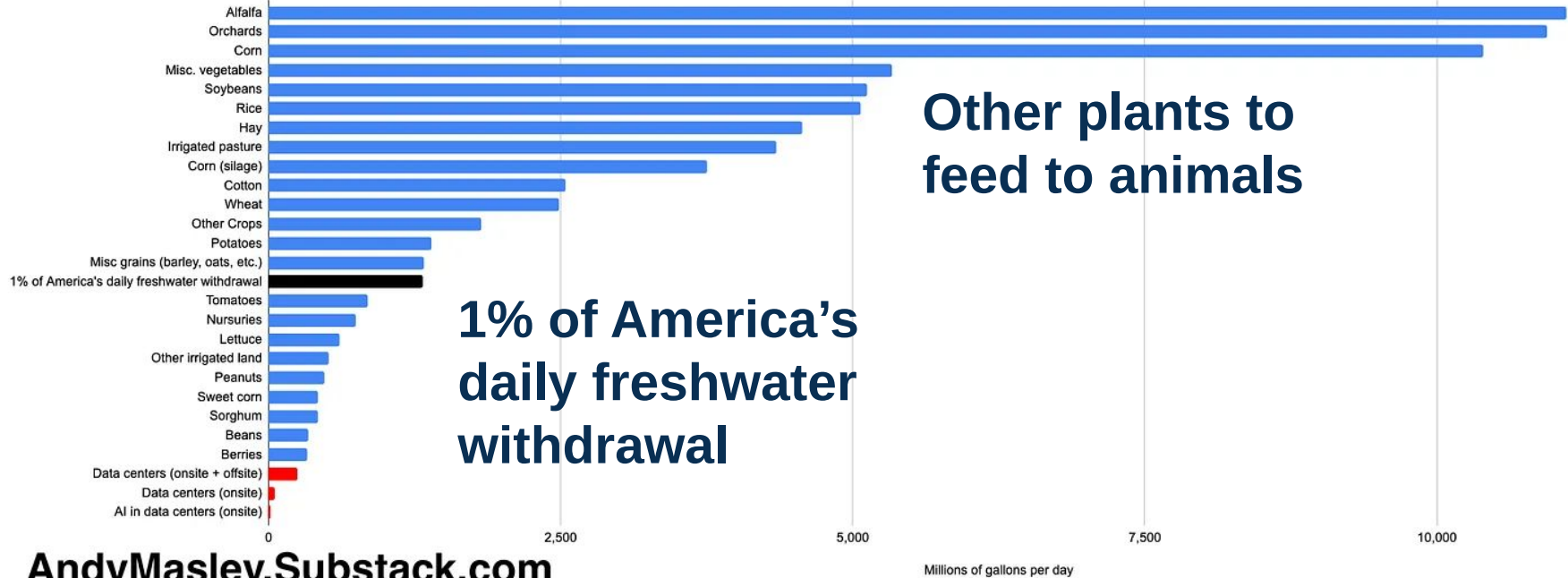
Part 4:

AI's environmental impact



National impact

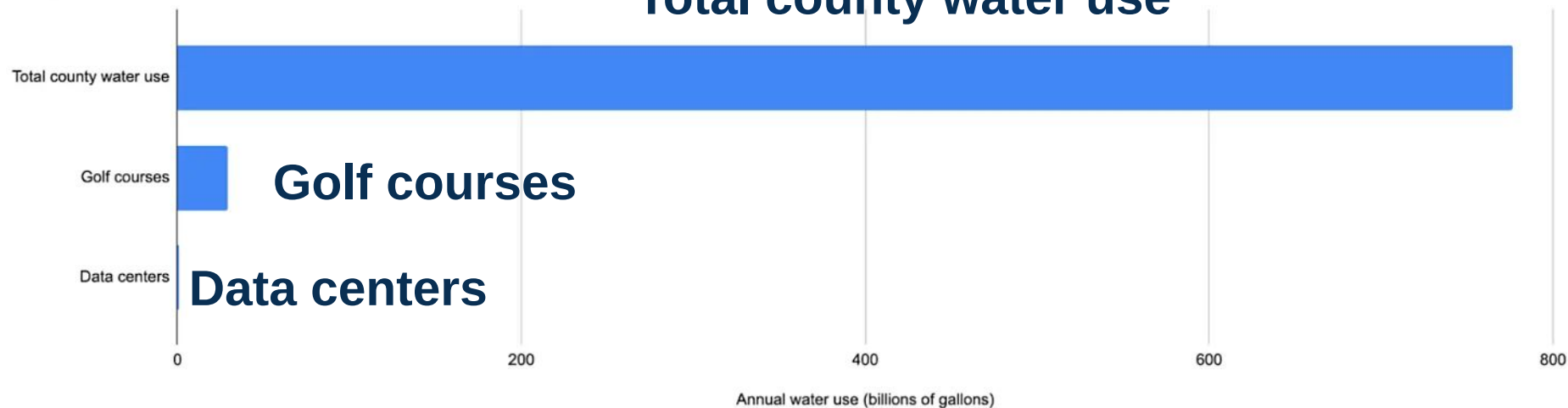
Alfalfa



Local impact

Water use in Maricopa County

Total county water use



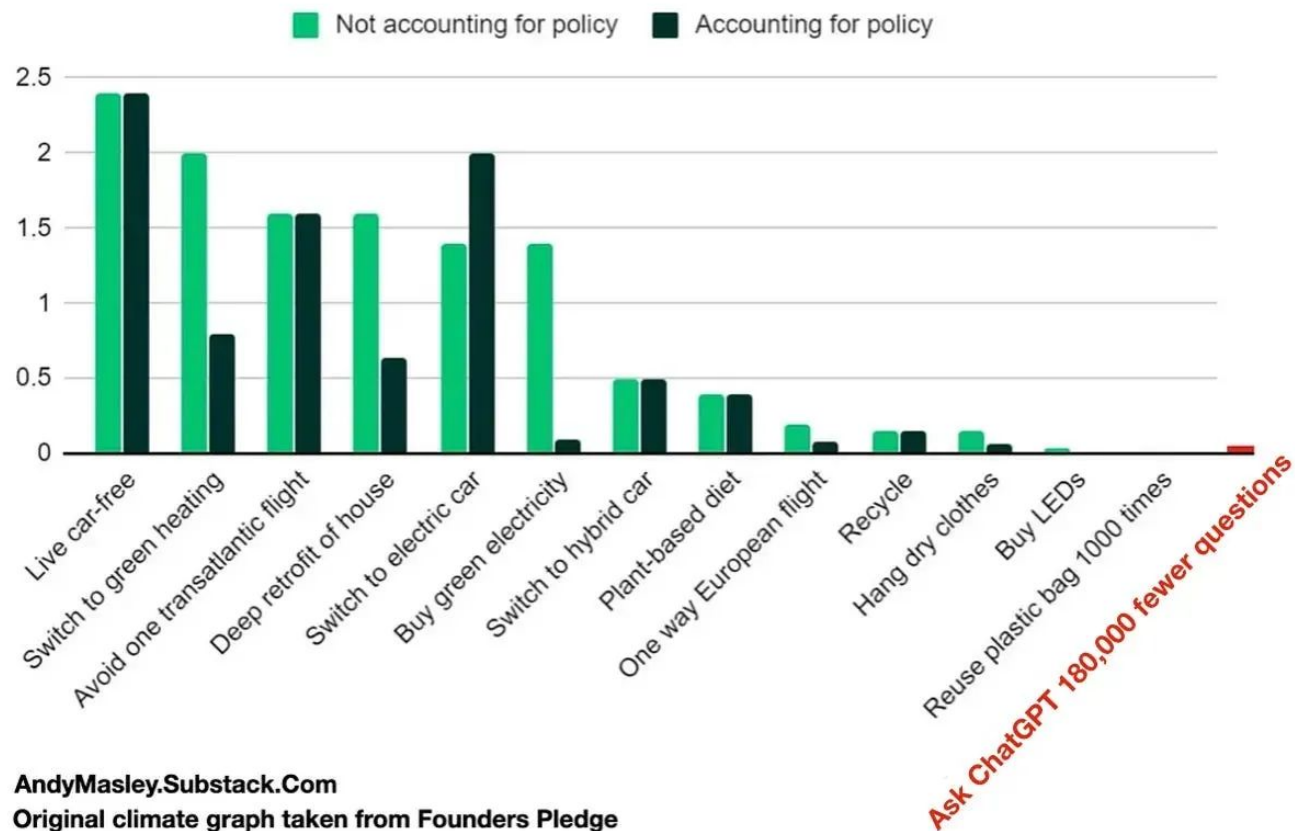
Funny stats

Here's a list of common objects you might own, and how many chatbot prompt's worth of water they used to make (all from this list, and using the onsite + offsite water value):

- **Leather Shoes** - 4,000,000 prompts' worth of water
- **Smartphone** - 6,400,000 prompts
- **Jeans** - 5,400,000 prompts
- **T-shirt** - 1,300,000 prompts
- **A single piece of paper** - 2550 prompts
- **A 400 page book** - 1,000,000 prompts



Figure 4. Tonnes of CO₂ avoided by selected personal lifestyle decisions accounting for government policy



Further Reading

<https://blog.andymasley.com/p/ai-and-the-environment>

Andy Masley



AI & the Environment

Animal Welfare

Artificial Intelligence

Effective Altruism

Politics

Recs & Advice

Misc

Links

Pod

AI & the Environment

I write a lot about AI's effects on the environment. I'm mostly pushing back against a lot of popular misconceptions and arguing that using AI is not bad for the environment. I'm also using this to share ideas and arguments from environmentalist ethics I think are important. I've split these up into sections and ordered each by which posts I'd read first. You can find these posts [organized as a normal Substack page here](#).



Further Reading

<https://www.currentaffairs.org/news/the-massive-climate-lie-that-will-destroy-human-civilization>

The Gargantuan Lie That is Collapsing The World's Climate



Thinking we have time left to address climate change, or that “Net Zero by 2050” will save us, is driving us toward full social collapse in ways that become more obvious with every new broken temperature record.

Adam McKay

filed 06 August 2026 in **CLIMATE CHANGE**



Further Reading

<https://tateschwartz.net/>

Home - Google Drive x F26 Climate Change by Tate - G... x Tate Schwartz x + Ask Gemini -

← → ↻ 🏠 🌐 tateschwartz.net ☆ 📁 🌍 ⋮

Hello!

TATE SCHWARTZ

IN IG EM

[A photo of me](#)

[Projects](#)

[Favorite things](#)

[Posts](#)

Welcome to my website • Look for the easter eggs hidden throughout • Click on the headers to go back a page

75°F Light rain Search ENG 6:01 PM 9/18/2026



Thank you for listening.

Final question:

What evidence would you have to see for you to change your (EA) beliefs?

- **Such as how nearterm / longterm you're thinking?**

